

Main Story

another expensive toy—not very smart.” When it comes to technology, humility is not a virtue that Pawar possesses.

And why should he, when his office and car are enough to send a geek into a tizzy.

His office is WiFi-enabled, and his Mitsubishi Pajero SUV is fitted with a Bluetooth-enabled phone, a Waypoint GPS receiver, the iTrip, a Pioneer S1 audio and video player with digital surround, and an unbreakable solar panel to recharge batteries while on treks.

he would have spent the rest of his life, had it not had a closing date. “The people at the stalls were a bit taken aback at my interest and my inquisitiveness. My knowledge comes as a surprise to them.”

He loves his old stuff, too. He has kept his first ever PDA—a damaged O2 XDA—at his office, as an antique piece. But he currently uses a Compaq iPAQ Pocket PC. His favourite acquisition is the Nokia 7650 the first phone with a one mega pixel camera.

Another cool one is the Yamaha digital guitar—a gadget that outputs both analog and digital signals, and thus can be connected directly to a PC to record and create music.

Not surprisingly, his event management company offers Web casts of high-profile events. Pawar also advises Bollywood biggies on which gadget to buy, the next time they are abroad. His

gizmos? Well, they come in “mostly through friends, from all over the world.”

On the other hand, Gupta’s Dell came through an auction site. Like all of Dell’s products, Gupta could customise his laptop. He settled for a configuration that cost him Rs 1.3 lakh. But he also got a three-year global warranty from Dell. “I’d love to own all the gadgets in the world, if I could afford them.”

Girish Mistry, veteran photographer and Dean of the Shari Academy, one of the only two professional photography institutes in India, swears by his Canon EOS 10D. On its



The Dell Inspiron 8500 can be customised to your needs

He uses his Waypoint receiver whenever he is abroad—especially Europe (“Amsterdam is my favourite place”) or in the US. When in Europe, he uses the TOM TOM Navigator software to get around, using his GPS receiver and PDA. Pawar is also a regular visitor to CeBIT, the world’s premier technology fair, held annually in the German city of Hanover, where



I’d love to own all the gadgets in the world, if I could afford them

Rohit Gupta
Director, Gupta Group

Top Ten

1. 40 GB Apple iPod with the iTrip FM transmitter
2. Bluetooth and WiFi enabled IBM ThinkPad T42p notebook
3. Dell Inspiron 8600
4. Nokia 6600
5. Nokia 7610 camera phone
6. Sony Ericsson P900
7. PalmOne Treo 600
8. PalmOne Tungsten T3
9. O2 XDA II
10. Toshiba e805 Pocket PC



If someone else has it, I don’t want it

Deepak Pawar
MD, Midas Events

Have Money, Will Buy

Celebrities of all kinds—from the Indian film industry to corporate biggies, find gizmo-buying the ultimate aphrodisiac. Or so it would seem, considering the gadgets they sport: If singer Shankar Mahadevan takes his Sony Ericsson P900 everywhere, actors Amitabh Bachchan, Preity Zinta, Shah Rukh Khan, Abhishek Bachchan, Vivek Oberoi, and Kamal Hassan are possessive of the Apple Powerbook.

So are musicians A R Rahman, Sandeep Chowta and Lucky Ali.

Shankar Mahadevan



Preity Zinta

also for Kolkata-based ad guru Ram Ray.

Model-turned-actor Marc Robinson owns a Nokia 3205, while cueist Geet Sethi dotes on his Palm Tungsten T.

Actors Sunny Deol

Shammi Kapoor

and Shekhar Suman are quite the gadget freaks and have made their

The Apple iBook is also the hot favourite of Shammi Kapoor, as



homes wire-free. So has Anil Kapoor, who uses Philips Pronto, a home automation device.

Celeb photographer Atul Kasbekar’s gizmos include a high-end Hasselblad 503 CW, a Fujifilm S2 Pro (35 mm) and a Nokia 6600.

Fashion designer Rohit Bal swears by his brand new Nokia 7600, the eye-shaped 3G phone.

iPod, the bestselling personal digital music player, has found fans in Sachin Tendulkar, Shah Rukh Khan,



Sachin Tendulkar

Infosys managing director Nandan Nilekani, DJ Aqueel and singer Lucky Ali.

If film world biggies are on to the gizmowagon, can politicians be far behind? Former Rajya Sabha member Vishvijit Prithvijit Singh, who ran Congress’ e-campaign, owns an Apple G-4 laptop, while former IT Minister and BJP spin-doctor Pramod Mahajan

is devoted to his laptop and mobile phones.

Rohit Bal



Pramod Mahajan

